

ENG 1005 · Practice Questions — Answer Key

Writing About Mystery and Thriller

Answers with brief explanations. (Instructor copy / self-check.)

#	Answer	Why
1	B (SC)	<i>While</i> makes it subordinate — it can't stand alone.
2	A (IC)	Complete thought: subject <i>inspector</i> + verb <i>dusted</i> .
3	B	An <i>-ing</i> phrase with no subject is a fragment; add a subject and a real verb.
4	A	Already a complete sentence (subject + verb + complete thought).
5	A	Comma + <i>then</i> joins two complete sentences — a comma splice; use a semicolon.
6	A	Two complete sentences with no punctuation (fused); separate with a semicolon.
7	A	Comma needed after the introductory phrase <i>Before dawn</i> .
8	B	The renaming phrase <i>a single feather</i> is non-essential — set it off with a pair of commas.
9	A	A colon follows a complete sentence to introduce an explanation; <i>revenge</i> isn't a full sentence, so not a semicolon.
10	B	Two complete, related sentences → join with a semicolon.
11	A	<i>Because</i> shows the cause-and-effect relationship between the two ideas.
12	A	<i>Although</i> shows the contrast; option C is a comma splice.
13	B	Three adjectives (<i>nervous, evasive, dishonest</i>) — same form, parallel.
14	B	Three <i>-ing</i> phrases (<i>reading, interviewing, running</i>) — parallel.
15	B	The door is locked, not the detective — keep the modifier next to <i>door</i> .
16	B	<i>Nearly</i> should sit next to <i>all</i> (she questioned nearly all of them).
17	B (were)	With <i>neither...nor</i> , the verb agrees with the nearer subject, <i>suspects</i> (plural).
18	A (its)	<i>Committee</i> is a collective noun acting as one unit → singular <i>its</i> .
19	B (me)	After the preposition <i>between</i> , use the object pronoun <i>me</i> .
20	A (tells)	<i>Each</i> is singular, so the verb is singular: <i>tells</i> .

Scoring: each question is worth 5%. 18–20 correct = excellent; 14–17 = good, review the misses; below 14 = revisit the Study Guide section for each topic.